Riipen

heyMilo

INTERVIEW REPORT

Gaurav Saini

Riipen Labs: Growth Strategy (cohort 2)

2026-04-11

Gaurav Saini

Riipen Labs: Growth Strategy (cohort 2)

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communication vague

CANDIDATE JOURNEY

31%

INTERVIEW

KEY STRENGTHS

- The candidate identified key improvements for the client's website and received positive feedback from their team.
- The candidate highlighted communication as a key skill developed during the project.

AREAS FOR IMPROVEMENT

- The candidate provided a basic description of their project but lacked specific details about their role and the project outcome.
- The candidate struggled to identify clear decision-making strategies when dealing with incomplete information.
- The candidate did not suggest any clear areas for improvement if repeating the project.

Web Interview

Completed: 2026-04-11

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INTERVIEW SCORE	COMMUNICATION
31%	2.8 / 5

EVALUATION DETAILS

1. To start us off, in your own words, briefly describe the project you just completed and your key role within the team

3/10

SUMMARY

- The candidate's response lacks a structured and clear overview of the project, making it difficult to understand the goal/problem and context. - The candidate vaguely mentions being a 'communications lead' but provides insufficient detail on specific responsibilities or contributions. - There is no clear segregation of the candidate's role from that of the team; the response uses vague language like 'we' frequently without specifying personal ownership. - Key project outcomes, deliverables, or success measurement criteria are not referenced, leaving the impact unclear. - While the candidate mentions issues with the company website, no concrete examples or results of changes made are provided. - Overall, the response lacks clarity, specificity, and evidence of ownership and impact.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses the candidate's ability to succinctly communicate recent, relevant work and accurately situate their contributions within a team context. Strong signals include: a clear project overview (goal/problem, stakeholders/users, constraints), the candidate's specific role and responsibilities, what they personally owned vs. what others owned, and the outcome or current status (what changed, how success was measured, what was delivered). Additional competence signals are appropriate level of detail for "brief," logical structure, use of concrete examples, awareness of cross-functional collaboration, and reflection on decisions/tradeoffs or lessons learned without oversharing confidential information. The intent is not to test polish or jargon, but clarity, ownership, and credibility about actual work performed.

SCORE OF 10

Response gives a clear, brief overview of a recent project that makes the goal/problem and context understandable (who it was for, why it mattered, notable constraints or requirements) and then accurately places the candidate's role within the team. The candidate specifies what they personally owned (decisions, components, responsibilities, deliverables) versus what others owned, and references collaboration with relevant partners when applicable. They include concrete examples (e.g., a key feature, analysis, process change) and summarize outcome/status in a grounded way (what shipped or changed, how success was assessed, what impact was observed or expected), optionally noting one tradeoff or lesson learned without relying on heavy jargon or revealing sensitive information.

SCORE OF 1

Response leaves the listener unable to understand what the project was or what the candidate actually did. The description is very vague or inconsistent (e.g., only buzzwords, unclear problem/goal, no identifiable users/stakeholders, no sense of scope or constraints), and the candidate cannot distinguish their responsibilities from the team's ("we did everything" or claiming credit for work without clarifying ownership). Key facts are missing such as what was delivered or the current status/outcome, and follow-up questions reveal limited direct involvement or an

unreliable account. The candidate may overshare confidential details or provide a narrative that suggests they did not meaningfully contribute or cannot credibly explain their contribution.

2. Tell me about a moment in this project where you had to make a decision with incomplete information. What were your options, what did you choose, and why?

3/10

SUMMARY

- The candidate did not provide a clear, concrete example of a decision made with incomplete information. - There was no detailed discussion of multiple options or substantial consideration of trade-offs. - The candidate's response focused on agreeing that information was minimal and suggested using AI but did not provide a well-reasoned explanation or comparison of options. - Limited engagement with reducing uncertainty or explicit measures to verify information reliability. - There is no mention of stakeholder management, escalation, or monitoring outcomes. - Some potential use of AI was indicated, but the thoroughness of the assessment and execution is unclear.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses judgment and decision-making under uncertainty, including how the candidate frames a problem, identifies what is unknown vs. knowable, considers multiple viable options, evaluates trade-offs (risk, impact, reversibility, time, stakeholder needs), and chooses an action with an appropriate level of confidence. Strong signals include: a concrete, personally-involved example; clear articulation of constraints and why information was incomplete; at least two realistic options considered; explicit reasoning tied to goals, data available, and risk tolerance; steps taken to reduce uncertainty (quick research, small tests, seeking expert input) without over-indexing on perfection; appropriate escalation or stakeholder alignment where needed; a plan for monitoring outcomes and adjusting; and reflection on what they learned and how they'd improve future decisions.

SCORE OF 10

The candidate provides a specific, high-signal example with real constraints and clearly distinguishes what was unknown, why it mattered, and what could realistically be learned in time. They describe multiple credible options (including doing nothing, delaying, or running a pilot), compare them using explicit criteria (impact, cost, time, reversibility, risk, customer/stakeholder needs), and explain why the chosen path matched the situation's risk profile. They show active uncertainty-reduction (targeted data gathering, quick experiments, scenario planning, consulting domain experts) while balancing speed and rigor, and they demonstrate sound stakeholder management (alignment, escalation when appropriate, clear communication of assumptions and risks). They also describe how they monitored outcomes and set triggers/contingencies to pivot, and they reflect thoughtfully on results and learning—showing improved decision-making habits rather than just a good outcome.

SCORE OF 1

The response lacks a real decision point or uses an example where uncertainty was trivial, avoiding ownership (e.g., "we just followed what we were told") or presenting hindsight certainty with no acknowledgment of unknowns. The candidate cannot name meaningful options, trade-offs, or criteria used, or the choice appears arbitrary ("gut feel" with no rationale) or reckless (ignoring material risks, user/customer impact, compliance/safety considerations, or clear warning signs). They show poor process signals such as failing to seek readily available information, refusing to consult relevant stakeholders when appropriate, over-escalating everything to avoid responsibility, or getting stuck in analysis without acting when time/impact required action. Little to no reflection is provided, or they externalize blame entirely and cannot describe how they monitored results or adapted after the decision.

3. Describe a time during this project when you helped your team overcome a challenge or contributed to team success. What actions did you take, and what was the impact?

3/10

SUMMARY

- The candidate mentioned the challenge of coordinating team schedules due to differing responsibilities (work, school, etc.), but this is a common issue lacking significant stakes or complexity. - No specific actions were taken beyond proposing night-time meetings, which is a minimal intervention and doesn't demonstrate significant problem-solving or process improvement. - The response lacks evidence of ownership, collaboration, communication strategies, or any innovative solutions to the scheduling problem. - There is no mention of measurable impact or learning from this experience that could be applied to future scenarios. - The overall impact described is narrow ('meeting at night'), lacking observable outcomes or improvements tied to project goals. - There is no substantial reflection on lessons learned or how the experience could influence future teamwork or problem-solving strategies.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses the candidate's ability to contribute to team effectiveness under real constraints: identifying a meaningful challenge, taking constructive action, collaborating across roles, and producing measurable or observable impact. Strong signals include a clear situation and stakes, the candidate's specific actions (communication, coordination, problem-solving, unblocking, conflict resolution, prioritization, or process improvement), evidence of shared ownership (crediting others and clarifying interfaces), and an outcome tied to team goals (delivery, quality, reliability, customer impact, or improved morale/clarity). Also listen for judgment and professionalism: how they diagnosed the root issue, navigated tradeoffs, escalated appropriately, used data or feedback, and learned or adjusted behavior. The rubric should reward a range of contribution types (technical, operational, interpersonal, planning, mentoring) as long as the candidate demonstrates purposeful actions and credible impact.

SCORE OF 10

The candidate provides a specific, relevant story with clear context, constraints, and what "success" meant for the team, then explains their actions in a way that demonstrates ownership, collaboration, and sound judgment. They describe concrete behaviors (e.g., clarifying goals/roles, facilitating alignment, unblocking dependencies, negotiating tradeoffs, improving a process, mediating conflict, sharing knowledge, creating visibility with stakeholders, or implementing a technical/operational fix) and explain why those actions were chosen. They appropriately involve others (seeking input, delegating, pairing, escalating with context) and communicate with empathy and clarity, giving credit where due while still making their personal contribution explicit. The impact is credible and specific—metrics if available (time saved, defect reduction, on-time delivery, incident reduction) or observable outcomes (reduced confusion, faster decisions, improved stakeholder trust)—and they include reflection on lessons learned and how they'd apply them in future team situations.

SCORE OF 1

The response lacks a concrete example or cannot explain what the challenge was, what they personally did, and what changed as a result. Red flags include portraying the issue as someone else's fault without demonstrating ownership, describing actions that are counterproductive (e.g., undermining teammates, ignoring stakeholders, refusing to collaborate, escalating prematurely or punitively), or showing poor judgment (e.g., making unilateral high-risk decisions with no consultation, repeatedly missing deadlines without mitigation). The impact is absent, purely speculative, or contradicted by the story (e.g., "I helped" but no steps or outcomes). The candidate cannot articulate how they worked with others (or implies they avoided teamwork entirely) and shows little reflection on what they learned or how they would handle a similar challenge differently.

4. Explain one insight or recommendation from your final deliverable as if you were presenting it to the client for the first time

5/10

SUMMARY

- The candidate identifies a significant issue with the client's website and their lack of social media presence as key insights from the deliverable. However, the insight is somewhat generic and lacks specificity. - They suggest the company should improve the website and its marketing strategies, including using social media and ads, but the explanation lacks detail on the expected impact or clear metrics of success. - The candidate provides a reasonable comparison with competitors as evidence but does not provide specific data or examples. - Communication is mostly clear, but there is frequent use of filler words such as 'like' and less structured presentation of ideas. - There is a lack of discussion on assumptions, limitations, or risks associated with the recommendations. - They briefly mention using AI for research, but do not elaborate on this methodology or its implications. - The response lacks a structured decision-oriented approach with clear context setting, outcome expectations, or implementation steps. - Overall, the candidate demonstrated some awareness and provided a basis for recommendations but lacked depth in their solution discussion and concrete next steps.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses the candidate's ability to translate analytical or project work into a client-ready insight: selecting a meaningful recommendation, explaining the "so what" in business terms, supporting it with appropriate evidence, and communicating with clarity, structure, and audience awareness. Signals of competence include: a clear framing of the client problem and decision context; a well-articulated insight/recommendation with expected impact; a concise explanation of the logic and key evidence (quantitative or qualitative) without overloading details; acknowledgement of assumptions, limitations, and risks; and a practical path forward (next steps, implementation considerations, or measurement). It also assesses stakeholder communication skills—confidence without overclaiming, responsiveness to likely client questions, and the ability to tailor language to a non-technical audience while remaining accurate.

SCORE OF 10

The candidate delivers a client-ready mini-presentation that is easy to follow and decision-oriented: they briefly set context, clearly articulate one specific insight/recommendation, and explain why it matters in terms of outcomes (revenue, cost, risk, customer experience, time). They support the recommendation with the right amount of evidence—key numbers, observed patterns, examples, or benchmarks—while explaining the reasoning chain and avoiding unnecessary detail; they translate technical work into plain language without losing accuracy. They surface assumptions and limitations appropriately, discuss tradeoffs and risks, and show pragmatic implementation thinking (who needs to do what, likely barriers, timeline, and how success will be measured). They communicate confidently yet responsibly (no overclaiming), anticipate likely client questions, and leave the client with a clear next step and a sense of expected impact and confidence level.

SCORE OF 1

The response shows material gaps that would make it hard for a client to understand or trust the recommendation: the candidate cannot clearly state the insight/recommendation, lacks a coherent narrative (problem → analysis → conclusion → action), or provides conclusions that do not follow from any cited evidence. They rely on jargon or deep technical detail without translating into business implications, or they make strong claims with no support, unclear assumptions, or evident misunderstandings of the client's goals/constraints. They may ignore feasibility (cost, timeline, operational realities), omit key risks/tradeoffs, or present a recommendation that is generic, irrelevant, or contradictory. Overall, the client would be left unsure what to do next, why it matters, or how confident they should be in the result.

5. Which skills from this project do you feel most confident carrying into a real workplace setting, and why?

3/10

SUMMARY

- Candidate identified communication as a key skill they would carry into the workplace. - Explanation was vague and centered mostly on their role as the communication lead but lacked details about what specific actions they took that highlight this ability. - Did not connect communication skills to specific project outcomes, constraints, or stakeholders' needs. - Lack of acknowledgment of areas for further development or a plan to address any potential limitations. - Limited discussion on how these skills would translate to a new environment or different settings, beyond general statements about workplace communication being important. - Overall, the response was vague with minimal evidence and reasoning about why communication would be beneficial or how it was specifically developed through the project.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses the candidate's ability to translate project experience into workplace-ready capabilities, including self-awareness about strengths, evidence-based reasoning, and understanding of professional context. Strong signals include: identifying 2–4 specific, transferable skills (technical, process, or interpersonal) grounded in concrete project actions; explaining "why" in terms of outcomes, constraints, stakeholders, or tradeoffs; naming the conditions under which the skills generalize (e.g., new domain, different tools, team setting) and what they would do similarly in a job; acknowledging boundaries (what they're less confident in yet, what support or learning plan they'd use); and communicating clearly without overclaiming. The rubric should reward diverse project types (school, personal, volunteer, work) and multiple valid skill categories (e.g., debugging, prioritization, communication, research, customer empathy, documentation, collaboration, quality, ownership).

SCORE OF 10

The response clearly and credibly identifies key skills from the project and demonstrates how they carry into a workplace setting, using specific evidence and reflective reasoning. Indicators include: selecting a focused set of transferable skills and anchoring each to concrete actions (e.g., "I created a test plan and caught X class of bugs," "I aligned requirements with a stakeholder and documented decisions," "I prioritized tasks under a deadline and adjusted scope"); explaining why those skills matter in real work (impact on quality, delivery, collaboration, customer value, risk); articulating context and tradeoffs (tools/constraints, team dynamics, decision rationale); acknowledging limitations with a realistic plan to ramp (what they'd learn next, how they seek feedback, how they mitigate risk); and demonstrating professional maturity—ownership, learning orientation, and respect for collaborators. The answer may be delivered in different styles, but it leaves the evaluator confident the candidate can reproduce these behaviors in a new environment.

SCORE OF 1

The response shows limited ability to connect the project to real workplace performance. Indicators include: naming only vague traits (e.g., "hardworking," "good at teamwork") with no concrete behaviors or examples; being unable to explain why the skill is transferable or what evidence supports it; overclaiming competence without acknowledging constraints or learning needs (e.g., asserting mastery while demonstrating misunderstandings of their own work); giving an answer inconsistent with the project described (suggesting they did not meaningfully contribute or cannot articulate their role); or displaying significant professional red flags such as blaming teammates, dismissing feedback, or showing lack of accountability for outcomes. A low score reflects missing substance or credibility, not nervousness, brevity, accent, or an unconventional communication style.

6. What would you do differently if you repeated this project?

2/10

SUMMARY

- The candidate stated they wouldn't do anything differently, indicating a lack of reflective practice (14:19). This suggests little or no learning from experience. - The candidate did mention that more information about the company would have been beneficial (14:58), but this relies on external factors rather than internal process improvements. - There was no clear articulation of specific areas under their control that could be improved in future projects. - The response lacked concrete steps or actionable improvements that could be implemented if the project were repeated. - Missed opportunity to demonstrate systems thinking or identifying root causes of challenges faced during the project.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses reflective practice and learning agility: whether the candidate can evaluate outcomes against goals, identify what they would change (process, planning, communication, technical choices, stakeholder management, risk/quality), and translate insights into actionable improvements. Strong signals include owning their role and decisions (without excessive self-blame), distinguishing controllable factors from constraints, using evidence (metrics, feedback, incidents) to justify changes, balancing trade-offs (time/cost/scope/quality), and describing concrete steps they would take next time (earlier alignment, better instrumentation, clearer requirements, staged rollout, stronger testing, improved delegation, tighter decision logs). The best answers show systems thinking (root causes, not just symptoms), appropriate humility, and an understanding of how to prevent recurrence or scale success in future projects.

SCORE OF 10

The response is specific, grounded, and actionable: they briefly set context (goal, their role, constraints), identify 1–3 meaningful changes they would make, and explain why using concrete evidence (what went wrong/right, metrics, stakeholder feedback, postmortem insights). They demonstrate ownership and balanced perspective—acknowledging both what they controlled and what they didn't—while avoiding blame and showing empathy for collaborators and stakeholders. Their improvements are practical and tailored (e.g., earlier requirement validation, clearer decision rights, better risk management, incremental delivery, improved testing/monitoring, sharper prioritization, more effective delegation), and they articulate expected impact and trade-offs. The answer indicates a repeatable learning process (retrospectives, documentation, feedback loops) and shows they can apply the lesson to future, similar work rather than treating it as a one-off.

SCORE OF 1

The response shows little or no learning or accountability: they claim they would change nothing despite mixed/poor outcomes, or only offer generic platitudes ("communicate more," "plan better") with no specific example, rationale, or actions. They primarily blame others or external factors without acknowledging their own choices or what was within their control, or they cannot articulate what "success" looked like or what evidence informed their view. Red flags include ignoring major issues that were clearly present (missed deadlines, quality problems, stakeholder conflict) without reflection, proposing changes that are misaligned with the project's goals/constraints (e.g., adding heavy process where speed was critical with no trade-off reasoning), or describing risky takeaways (e.g., skipping reviews/testing, avoiding stakeholders) that would likely repeat or worsen problems.

7. What is one insight about yourself that this project helped you discover?

3/10

SUMMARY

- Candidate provided a very generic insight about working well in teams. - The response lacks specificity and depth regarding self-awareness or new learning. - No specific moments, feedback, or outcomes from the project were cited to substantiate this realization. - The candidate did not mention any adaptations or plans to improve teamwork based on the insight. - The response is authentic but lacks reflective depth and actionable learning that aligns with improvement in future performance.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

This question assesses self-awareness, learning agility, and reflective practice: whether the candidate can articulate a meaningful personal insight that arose from real project experience, connect it to concrete evidence (moments, feedback, outcomes), and translate it into implications for how they work going forward. Strong signals include identifying a specific behavior/pattern (strength, limitation, preference, bias, assumption, communication tendency), explaining what triggered the realization during the project, demonstrating ownership without over-indexing on self-criticism, and showing how they adapted (or plan to adapt) in a way that benefits collaborators and results. Look for authenticity, clarity, and a constructive framing that indicates the candidate learns from experience; the insight can be technical, interpersonal, process-oriented, or values-driven, as long as it is grounded and actionable.

SCORE OF 10

The candidate shares a clear, non-trivial insight about themselves that is credibly tied to the project ("I realized I default to solving alone when timelines tighten, which reduced alignment"), cites specific triggering moments or feedback, and explains how it affected outcomes. They demonstrate balanced self-evaluation—owning their role without undue self-flagellation—along with concrete adjustments they made or will make (e.g., earlier stakeholder check-ins, documenting assumptions, delegating differently, seeking critique sooner, changing how they structure work). The insight is framed as actionable learning that improves team effectiveness and delivery, and the explanation is coherent and authentic, showing reflective depth and the ability to convert experience into better future performance across contexts.

SCORE OF 1

The response lacks a real insight or is ungrounded: it stays generic ("I learned a lot," "I'm a hard worker"), reads like a slogan, or cannot point to any project-specific evidence. Red flags include externalizing blame ("I learned others are incompetent"), dismissing reflection ("nothing new about myself"), showing little ownership for outcomes, or describing an "insight" that signals problematic working norms (e.g., unwillingness to collaborate, disrespect for stakeholders, resistance to feedback, ethical indifference). Another poor indicator is mentioning a significant limitation revealed by the project but showing no learning, mitigation, or plan to address it, suggesting low learning agility or poor judgment rather than mere communication style differences.

WEB INTERVIEW TRANSCRIPT

INTERVIEWER 00:00
Hi, Gaurav Saini.

INTERVIEWER 00:01
Welcome to your interview with the FuturePath team.

INTERVIEWER 00:04
My name is Taylor, and I'm here to help you perform your best.

INTERVIEWER 00:07
Should we get started?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 00:09
Yes.

INTERVIEWER 00:12
The interview is designed to allow you to be reflective about your experience and how you have learned durable skills such as critical thinking, professionalism, and teamwork.

INTERVIEWER 00:21
Be yourself and be willing to share specifics about how you tackled this ripened lab.

INTERVIEWER 00:25
To start us off, in your own words, briefly describe the project you just completed and your key role within the team.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 00:32
Okay.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 00:33
So my the project I completed was pretty nice.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 00:36
I was the communications lead, and I was pretty okay with my role.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 00:43

Overall, it was a great experience, and I got to work with the team of others as well, which were also pretty collaborative in my opinion.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 00:51

But yeah.

INTERVIEWER 00:56

Could you provide a bit more detail about the project itself?

INTERVIEWER 00:59

Specifically, what was the main goal or problem the project aimed to address, and what were some of your specific responsibilities as the communications lead?

INTERVIEWER 01:06

Also, how did you measure the success of the project, or what was the outcome?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 01:11

So, basically, what we were doing is just improving a company overall.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 01:16

Even like so the company that we were working on, they had very little information to begin with.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 01:23

Even the website that we started with, they hardly had any information on it at all.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 01:28

But based off the information we had, we were able to, like, come up with, like, a project plan or some type of solution, and we were able to address those issues and then come up with some ideas on how to fix those issues.

INTERVIEWER 01:44

Thank you for sharing that.

INTERVIEWER 01:46

It sounds like you played a significant role in addressing communication gaps.

INTERVIEWER 01:49

Can you tell me more about the specific actions you took as the communications lead?

INTERVIEWER 01:53

What were some of the ideas or solutions you proposed to improve the company's communication and information dissemination?

INTERVIEWER 01:59

Additionally, how did your team collaborate to ensure these solutions were implemented?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:04

Okay.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:04

So one major thing that we realized right off the bat, even when we, like, opened their website, one thing that we noticed right away was that the website doesn't, like it's not, a proper actual website.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:17

It's, like, very basic, like, very minimal information.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:21

What we understood was it has something to do with, like, construction type of stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:26

They handle supplies and all that type of stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:29

So, basically, we got information.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:31

We use a little bit of, like, research and stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 02:34

Based off that, we were able to, like, come up with a solution for what we could do to improve this specific company's needs.

INTERVIEWER 02:46

It sounds like you identified a key issue with the company's website and then used research to develop solutions.

INTERVIEWER 02:51

Can you elaborate on the specific research methods you used to gather information?

INTERVIEWER 02:55

Also, what were some of the improvements or changes you suggested for the website, and how did you present these ideas to your team or stakeholders?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:03

So, basically, one major thing that we saw was the the layout and everything of the website was, like, pretty basic.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:09

It was, like, some kid developed the website.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:12

That's how terrible it was.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:13

It was, like, just one page.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:15

So some things that we addressed was, you should probably remake your website, probably get it done by some professional and, like, software development or web development specific.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:29

It will be better and, like, more information on it because what they have on the current website is very basic.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:36

And some basic research methods that we use was just basically Google and stuff and what Riipen Labs provided for the specific company on their description.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 03:47

Based off the information, we were able to, like, come up with a solution for

INTERVIEWER 03:56

The website redesign.

INTERVIEWER 03:58

It's clear you identified significant areas for improvement.

INTERVIEWER 04:01

How did your team respond to your suggestions about remaking the website?

INTERVIEWER 04:04
What was the overall outcome of your recommendations, and how did you measure success in this project?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:10
So based on my teammates, they were also in the same boat as me.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:14
They're like, hey.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:15
There's very minimal information present at the moment.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:18
So one thing we could definitely write down is that the website in specific does need to be updated because right now what they have is not good at all.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:26
And whoever comes to the website easily gets confused.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:29
So my team was pretty collaborative about that, and they were very happy with the idea I presented.

INTERVIEWER 04:39
It's great to hear that your team was supportive of your suggestions.

INTERVIEWER 04:42
Moving on to the next question.

INTERVIEWER 04:44
Can you tell me about a moment in this project where you had to make a decision with incomplete information?

INTERVIEWER 04:48
What were your options?

INTERVIEWER 04:49
What did you choose, and why?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:53

So like I mentioned earlier, whatever was there was basically incomplete to begin with.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 04:58

So whatever there was, it was very minimal information.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:02

And based off all the stuff that I mentioned earlier, What I mentioned earlier is what I would recommend.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:13

Overall website needed to be changed and all this type of stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:17

A lot more information need to be present even on Ripen Labs because it wasn't, like, really clear on what the company is and what they do.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:24

The best way that we approached it was whatever information they had on their website.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:30

I use, like, AI to, like, figure out what they have and all those type of stuff and then, like, probably get a more clear, like, description of what they're trying to say.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:40

That's probably, like, the best approach that me and my teammates were able to come up with.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:46

As for areas for improvement, I can't really there's, like, so many.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 05:51

Like, there's nothing one specific thing that I could point out, but there's, like, so many things that come from you to be improved on.

INTERVIEWER 06:01

It sounds like you had to navigate quite a bit of uncertainty.

INTERVIEWER 06:03

Can you clarify what specific options you considered for addressing the incomplete information?

INTERVIEWER 06:07

For instance, did you weigh the benefits of using AI versus other research methods?

INTERVIEWER 06:11

What led you to choose that approach, and how did you ensure that the information you gathered was reliable?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 06:17

So, basically, the information that was present on Riipen and what was present on the website, from what we know, if it was accurate or not, was we matched them to see if they were, like, basically the same type of information or something similar related.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 06:32

Based off that, we were able to, see if using AI was reliable in this type of situation.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 06:39

And, yeah, that's what I would say.

INTERVIEWER 06:44

Thank you for explaining that process.

INTERVIEWER 06:46

It seems like you took a thoughtful approach to verify the information.

INTERVIEWER 06:48

Now let's move on to the next question.

INTERVIEWER 06:50

Describe a time during this project when you helped your team overcome a challenge or contributed to team success.

INTERVIEWER 06:55

What actions did you take, and what was the impact?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 06:58

So, basically, there were times like, for example, some of us, like, there's some that are working part time, some are full time.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:07

You know?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:08

Like, everyone has a different time.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:10

Or, actually, some people are also in school and stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:12

Right?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:15

What I would say is, like, the only challenge that we faced was, like, basically coming up with the time to meet.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:22

The meeting time was only was probably one of the major things that we faced during this entire process.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:32

Yeah.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:32

That's basically what I would say.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:33

Like, just talking I mean, talking over, like, text and stuff, like, using ripen's chat stuff and all that.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:40

That's easy, but, like, coming together as a one group and making sure all our time slots are available is, like, kind of the difficult part because everyone is busy at their own times.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:52

But what worked out the most is, like, during nighttime hours, probably, like, nine or 10PM.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 07:57

I would say probably are, like, the best hour that we were able to, like, agree upon because that's the time we're all free.

INTERVIEWER 08:05

It sounds like coordinating schedules was a significant challenge.

INTERVIEWER 08:08

What specific actions did you take to help your team overcome the scheduling issue?

INTERVIEWER 08:12

Did you suggest any strategies for better communication or planning that enabled your team to meet more effectively?

INTERVIEWER 08:17

What was the impact of those actions on the overall progress of the project?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 08:21

So, yeah, we did meet a couple of times.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 08:25

So we would basically, like, message in the group chat, basically, like, a day prior and, like, agree upon the time.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 08:32

A day allows everyone to, like, read through the messages and, like, agree, basically.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 08:38

Right?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 08:38

So I would say, like, in order to, like, coordinate properly, we would, like, do our communication about the meeting, like, a day prior.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 08:50

And then the next day, we would host the meeting during night ten hours plus dust when everyone else is free.

INTERVIEWER 08:56

That sounds like a solid approach to facilitate communication and coordination.

INTERVIEWER 09:00

Now let's move on to the next question.

INTERVIEWER 09:02

Explain one insight or recommendation from your final deliverable as if you were presenting it to the client for the first time.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 09:10

Sure.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 09:11

If you just give me a minute, let me just pull up the documents so I could tell you.

INTERVIEWER 09:16

Take your time.

INTERVIEWER 09:17

Let me know when you're ready to continue.

INTERVIEWER 09:38

Hey.

INTERVIEWER 09:39

Are you still there?

INTERVIEWER 09:40

Just checking in.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 09:42

Yes.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 09:42

Just give me a minute, please.

INTERVIEWER 09:46

Of course, take your time.

INTERVIEWER 09:48

I'm here when you're ready.

INTERVIEWER 10:09
Hey.

INTERVIEWER 10:10
Are you still there?

INTERVIEWER 10:11
Just checking in.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:13
Yeah.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:13
Just give me one minute.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:14
I'm just looking through the document.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:16
Please just give me a minute.

INTERVIEWER 10:19
Absolutely.

INTERVIEWER 10:20
Take your time.

INTERVIEWER 10:21
I'm here when you're ready.

INTERVIEWER 10:41
Hey.

INTERVIEWER 10:41
Are you still there?

INTERVIEWER 10:42
Just checking in.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:46
Yeah.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:47
So, basically, the final deliverables, what I see in this document is we came up with a solution.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 10:58
The company is to be more clear of what they need to do.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:02
What they are presenting right now is not, like, that well written or anything.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:08
The recommendations that we post, like I mentioned earlier, the website and specific needs to be developed better.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:14
Their marketing strategies also needs to be improved as well because what they have at the moment is not working out that well.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:22
They need to also, like, publish themselves.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:25
I will use social media to present themselves and stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:28
Because currently, I don't really see any of that.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:30
So, like, I don't know.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:31
Try running ads something.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:33

You know?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 11:33

Like, that's one of the few things we would recommend as a group to present yourself as a company.

INTERVIEWER 11:46

It seems you provided some valuable insights regarding the company's marketing and online presence.

INTERVIEWER 11:50

How would you communicate the importance of these recommendations to the client?

INTERVIEWER 11:54

What evidence or reasoning would you use to highlight the expected impact of implementing these changes?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:00

So what I could say is I could probably compare their company with other companies that are doing the exact same things as them.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:08

But instead, you'll see that other companies do have social medias, ads, marketing, and all those type of things, which are helping them succeed.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:19

Meanwhile, this company is not succeeding as much.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:21

Right?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:21

So I would probably use that as evidence or reason for this specific company.

INTERVIEWER 12:31

That's a strong approach to provide context and support for your recommendations.

INTERVIEWER 12:35

Moving on to the next question.

INTERVIEWER 12:37

Which skills from this project do you feel most confident carrying into a real workplace setting, and why?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:42

I would say the one skill that I would I think I'd probably gain the most was probably communication.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:50

I I play, like, a key role in, like, making sure everyone is talking to each other and stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:56

Right?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 12:56

So, like, I was, the center point of me and all the other people that are in the team.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:03

So whatever there was, like, I would always, like, communicate and stuff.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:06

Even, like, during the meetings, I would always speak because normally, I'm not the type of guy that would, like, speak a lot.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:11

Right?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:12

So I say probably communication would be one of the best skills that I gained.

INTERVIEWER 13:18

It's great to hear that you developed your communication skills throughout the project.

INTERVIEWER 13:22

Can you elaborate on how you plan to apply these communication skills in a real workplace setting?

INTERVIEWER 13:26

Are there specific situations or contexts where you think they will be particularly beneficial?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:31

Yes.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:32

Communication is one of one of the most essential things you should have.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:36

Like, even when you're working in, like, any company, like, communicating with, like, team and stuff is, like, necessary.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:43

Otherwise, like, you might be working on something else, and the other group needs might be working on completely something else.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:49

You know?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:49

Like, having communication, like, keeps the entire team attached as one.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:55

You know?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 13:56

So, yeah, that's the reason why I would say communication is probably the skill that would come real handy in, like, real life workplaces.

INTERVIEWER 14:09

That's a thoughtful perspective on the importance of communication and teamwork.

INTERVIEWER 14:13

Now what would you do differently if you repeated this project?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 14:19

What I would do differently, I don't really know if I would do anything differently, to be honest.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 14:28

Like, what I did, I think I did fine, but I don't really see anything that I would do differently, in specific.

INTERVIEWER 14:39

It sounds like you felt confident in your approach and contributions.

INTERVIEWER 14:42

However, can you think of any potential improvements or strategies that could enhance the project workflow or team dynamics even if they are minor?

INTERVIEWER 14:49

For example, were there any aspects of the process that could be streamlined or any additional tools that could have been helpful?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 14:58

I mean, if we had more information about the company, that would be something that was more that would have been more helpful.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:04

But, like, whatever we had, we had to, like, work with it.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:07

You know?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:07

Like, we can't really do anything about it.

INTERVIEWER 15:11

That's a valid point about the importance of having comprehensive information for better decision making.

INTERVIEWER 15:16

Lastly, what is one insight about yourself that this project helped you discover?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:23

I work pretty well in teams.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:25

That's one thing that I discovered.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:27

So, like, even in the past, like, in school and stuff, like, we're working together as a group is, like, one major thing, especially, like, for, like, development process.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:37

Right?

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 15:38

So I would say probably, like, teamwork is, like, probably my most valid or thing I learned or discovered about myself.

INTERVIEWER 15:53

That's a valuable insight to have gained about your ability to work in teams.

INTERVIEWER 15:56

Thank you for sharing.

INTERVIEWER 15:58

That concludes our questions for today.

INTERVIEWER 15:59

It was nice speaking with you.

GAURAV SAINI - CANDIDATE 16:03

Thank you.

INTERVIEWER 16:05

Your interview is now complete.

INTERVIEWER 16:07

When you leave the interview, your interview summary will be generated and then automatically passed back to Riipen.

INTERVIEWER 16:13

Your Riipen milestone will be marked complete when this step finishes.